

SANSKRIT • FROM DAY ONE

Foundation Coursebook

A 20-day, transliteration-first introduction to pronouns, subject and object forms, noun declension, and present-tense verb conjugation.

IAST first • Devanāgarī alongside • explanations, model sentences, guided practice, diagnostics, and a full learning roadmap

PHASE 1 • ENGLISH-SPEAKER EDITION • 2026

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How to use this course

This is a first course in **Classical Sanskrit** for an English-speaking learner who starts with no spoken Sanskrit. IAST roman transliteration is always presented first. Devanāgarī appears beside it so that the script becomes familiar without blocking grammar or reading.

The key correction

Nouns and pronouns decline; verbs conjugate. A noun or pronoun changes form to show whether it is a subject or object. A verb changes form to show the subject's person and number. In an active sentence, the direct object does **not** choose the verb ending.

What you will be able to do after Day 20

- Read normalized IAST accurately enough to distinguish forms such as rāma, rāmā, and rāmam.
- Identify the subject, direct object, and finite verb even when Sanskrit word order changes.
- Use nominative and accusative forms of common masculine, feminine, and neuter a/ā-stem words.
- Use subject and object forms of first-, second-, and third-person pronouns in singular, dual, and plural.
- Conjugate regular present-tense parasmaipada verbs in all nine person-number combinations.
- Recognize the present ātmanepada ending set and five high-frequency irregular present stems.
- Parse and translate a short controlled Sanskrit passage without relying on English word order.

A daily 50-minute routine

Minutes	Activity	Why it matters
0-5	Closed-book recall	Say yesterday's forms before looking.
5-18	New lesson	Read the explanation and speak every Sanskrit example.
18-30	Guided analysis	Label subject, object, verb, case, person, and number.
30-43	Workbook	Retrieve forms; do not merely copy a chart.
43-50	Production	Say or write three new sentences from the day's pattern.

Course conventions

- **IAST first:** rāmaḥ phalaṃ khādati is the line you learn and pronounce.
- **Devanāgarī second:** रामः फलं खादति is always paired with transliteration; you are never expected to decode it alone.
- **Stem in a vocabulary list:** rāma- means the stem. The hyphen is a teaching mark, not part of the word.
- **Root sign:** gam means the lexical root “go.” A usable present stem may look different: gaccha-.
- **Learning forms and sandhi:** early charts show endings clearly. Connected-speech changes are noted but not tested in this phase.

Mastery rule

Move on when you can answer at least 80% of the day's workbook items without the chart and can explain each correction. A wrong answer that you diagnose is useful; a guessed answer that happens to be right is not yet mastery.

The 20-day plan

Day	Lesson	Core grammar
1	The sentence engine	subject, object, verb; default S-O-V
2	Read IAST accurately	vowel length, aspiration, retroflexion, ṃ and ḥ
3	Stems and endings	gender, three numbers, eight cases; root vs stem
4	Your first verbs	present meaning, third-person singular, omitted subjects
5	Masculine a-stems	nominative vs accusative singular
6	Neuter a-stems	the nominative = accusative rule
7	Week 1 integration	parse, translate, and switch roles
8	Person and number	the nine-cell agreement grid
9	I, you, he, she, it	subject pronouns and -mi/-si/-ti
10	Me, you, him, her, it	object pronouns; no object agreement
11	Exactly two-and more	dual and plural noun forms
12	Complete present endings	all nine parasmaipada forms
13	Full I/we and you	asmad and yuṣmad in cases 1 and 2
14	Cumulative review	diagnose the five most common errors
15	The pronoun tad	he/she/it/they across gender and number
16	Who sees whom?	interrogative pronouns in subject/object roles
17	Adjective agreement	gender, number, and case agreement
18	The second ending set	present ātmanepada with labhate
19	Roots and irregulars	gam, dṛś, sthā, pā, and as
20	Capstone	read, parse, translate, and compose independently

Before Day 1: the grammar map

Sanskrit packs information into word endings. English often depends on fixed word order and helper words; Sanskrit can mark the same relationships directly on nouns, pronouns, and verbs.

Job	English example	Sanskrit mechanism	Traditional term
Subject	He sees her.	nominative / case 1	prathamā vibhaktiḥ
Direct object	He sees her .	accusative / case 2	dvitīyā vibhaktiḥ
Noun/pronoun form	he him	declension	subanta morphology
Verb form	see sees	conjugation	tiṅanta morphology
Agreement	I see / he sees	verb tracks subject	puruṣa + vacana

One sentence to remember

aham tvāṃ paśyāmi - “I see you.” aham is nominative, tvāṃ/tvām is accusative, and paśyāmi is first-person singular because aham is the subject.

Why this course postpones most sandhi

Sandhi is the regular sound change that occurs where sounds meet. It can hide the endings you are trying to learn: rāmaḥ + atra becomes rāmo 'tra. During this phase, you learn the underlying forms first and receive only the sandhi needed to read the examples. A later phase will make sandhi systematic.

Day 1: The sentence engine

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. Three jobs, not three positions

Start with the three-part sentence **subject - direct object - verb**. Sanskrit's neutral prose order is often S-O-V, but endings carry more grammatical weight than position. The subject performs or controls the active action. The direct object is the entity directly affected, perceived, or produced.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
rāmaḥ sītāṃ paśyati.	रामः सीतां पश्यति	Rama sees Sita. rāmaḥ = subject; sītāṃ = object; paśyati = verb
sītā rāmaṃ paśyati.	सीता रामं पश्यति	Sita sees Rama. sītā = subject; rāmaṃ = object
rāmaṃ sītā paśyati.	रामं सीता पश्यति	Sita sees Rama. same endings; object is placed first for emphasis

2. The endings are grammatical labels

English still shows a small version of case in pronouns: he is a subject form, while him is an object form. Sanskrit applies this idea to nouns, adjectives, and pronouns much more consistently.

Role	English	Sanskrit	Label
Subject	he	saḥ	nominative / case 1
Object	him	tam	accusative / case 2
Subject	Rama	rāmaḥ	nominative / case 1
Object	Rama	rāmaṃ	accusative / case 2

3. The verb follows the subject

The active verb agrees with the **subject**. Compare the English contrast “I see” and “he sees.” Sanskrit makes this agreement much richer, because it distinguishes three persons and three numbers. For today, simply notice that paśyati means “he/she/it sees” or “[a named singular subject] sees.”

Never attach the verb to the object

In rāmaḥ sītāṃ paśyati, the verb is singular because the subject rāmaḥ is singular. Changing the object to two or many Sitas will not change paśyati as long as Rama remains the subject.

Guided practice

Label S (subject), O (object), and V (verb): kṛṣṇaḥ phalaṃ khādati. Then translate literally in Sanskrit order.

Check: kṛṣṇaḥ = S; phalaṃ/phalaṃ = O; khādati = V. Literal order: “Krishna fruit eats.” Natural English: “Krishna eats the fruit.”

Close the lesson

- Default Sanskrit prose order is often subject-object-verb, but endings identify the roles.
- Nominative marks the ordinary active subject; accusative marks the ordinary direct object.
- The active verb agrees with the subject, never with the direct object.

Before tomorrow

Say the three model sentences aloud twice. In the workbook, do Day 1 without looking back until you reach the production section.

Day 2: Read IAST accurately

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. IAST is a sound map

IAST uses the Roman alphabet plus diacritics so that each spelling points to a specific Sanskrit sound. Do not treat the marks as decoration: a and ā, or t and ṭ, can distinguish words and forms.

Symbol	Approximation for an English speaker	Contrast to preserve
a / ā	a in "about" / a in "father," held longer	rāma has long ā
i / ī	short 'ee' / long 'ee'	length is meaningful
u / ū	short 'oo' / long 'oo'	keep lips rounded
ṛ	a syllabic r; begin with 'ri' if needed	kṛṣṇa, not 'krishna' with no vowel
t d n	tongue at upper teeth	dental series
ṭ ḍ ṇ	tongue tip curled slightly back	retroflex series
th / ṭh	t or ṭ plus a puff of air	never English 'th' in "thin"
ś / ṣ / s	three sibilants; sh / retroflex sh / s	distinguish gradually
ṁ	nasal resonance before a following sound	often represents final -m before a consonant
ḥ	soft breath after the preceding vowel	often comes from final -s

2. Five forms worth pronouncing

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
rāmaḥ	रामः	Rama (subject) long ā; final visarga ḥ
kṛṣṇaḥ	कृष्णः	Krishna (subject) syllabic ṛ; retroflex ṣ and ṇ
phalam	फलम्	fruit (citation form) ph is p + breath, not f
phalaṁ khādati	फलं खादति	eats fruit final -m appears as ṁ before kh
paśyati	पश्यति	sees ś is a palatal 'sh'; y begins the next syllable
tvam	त्वम्	you (subject) t and v begin one cluster: tvam

3. Two surface spellings you will meet immediately

The accusative singular ending is taught as **-am**. Before most consonants it is written as **-aṃ**: phalam + khādati phalaṃ khādati. The underlying case ending has not changed. Likewise, final -aḥ can change before a voiced sound, but early charts retain the clear citation form.

Pronunciation standard

Aim first for contrasts, not an accent: keep long vowels long, never pronounce aspirated stops as English fricatives, and distinguish dental from retroflex when you can. Perfect recitation is a later layer; accurate grammatical recognition starts now.

Guided practice

Which feature changes in each pair: rāma / ramā, tā / ta, phala / fala, nara / ṇara?

Check: rāma / ramā: vowel location and length; tā / ta: vowel length; phala / fala: aspirated stop vs English-like fricative; nara / ṇara: dental vs retroflex nasal.

Close the lesson

- IAST diacritics represent real distinctions.
- Long vowels should receive roughly twice the duration of short vowels.
- The spellings -am and -aṃ can represent the same accusative ending in different sound environments.

Before tomorrow

Record yourself saying the six model forms once. Listen back only for vowel length, aspiration, and ḥ/ṃ-not for an idealized accent.

Day 3: Stems, endings, and the grammar grid

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. A word form has a reusable base and an ending

A nominal stem is the form listed in a grammar or lexicon before case endings are attached. For example, *rāma-* is a masculine stem. Its subject form is *rāmaḥ*; its direct-object form is *rāmam*. The stem carries the lexical meaning, while the ending expresses grammatical information.

Stem	Gender	Nominative singular	Accusative singular
<i>rāma-</i>	masculine	<i>rāmaḥ</i>	<i>rāmam</i>
<i>sītā-</i>	feminine	<i>sītā</i>	<i>sītām</i>
<i>phala-</i>	neuter	<i>phalam</i>	<i>phalam</i>

2. Every finite noun form occupies three coordinates

A declined noun or pronoun is identified by **gender**, **number**, and **case**. Sanskrit has three grammatical genders, three numbers, and eight cases. This phase emphasizes cases 1 and 2, but you should see the full map from the beginning.

Dimension	Values	Question answered
Gender (liṅga)	masculine, feminine, neuter	Which declensional agreement pattern?
Number (vacana)	singular, dual, plural	One, exactly two, or more than two?
Case (vibhakti)	1-8	What grammatical relationship does the form express?

3. Verbs have a different architecture

A verb begins from a lexical root (dhātu), forms a tense/mood stem, and takes a personal ending. Do not expect the visible present stem always to resemble the dictionary root.

Root	Present stem	Finite form	Meaning
gam	<i>gaccha-</i>	<i>gacchati</i>	he/she/it goes
ḍṛś	<i>paśya-</i>	<i>paśyati</i>	he/she/it sees
vad	<i>vada-</i>	<i>vadati</i>	he/she/it speaks

The eight cases: recognition map

Case	English name	Core beginner cue
1 - prathamā	nominative	subject / default
2 - dvitīyā	accusative	direct object / destination
3 - tṛtīyā	instrumental	with / by means of
4 - caturthī	dative	to / for
5 - pañcamī	ablative	from / because of
6 - ṣaṣṭhī	genitive	of / possession
7 - saptaṁī	locative	in / on
8 - sambodhana	vocative	direct address

Guided practice

Parse rāmam as fully as today allows: identify stem, gender, number, and case.

Check: Stem rāma-; masculine; singular; accusative (case 2). Its ordinary function is direct object.

Close the lesson

- Nominals encode gender, number, and case.
- A finite verb encodes at least person and number, along with tense/mood and an ending set.
- Dictionary root, present stem, and finished verb form are related but not identical.

Before tomorrow

Make three index cards: rāma- rāmaḥ / rāmam; sītā- sītā / sītām; phala- phalam / phalam.

Day 4: Your first verbs

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. The present tense is broader than English present

A Sanskrit present form can correspond to English “goes,” “is going,” or a habitual “goes regularly.” Context supplies the difference. Today’s forms are third-person singular: they pair with “he,” “she,” “it,” or one named subject.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
gacchati	गच्छति	goes / is going present stem gaccha-
paśyati	पश्यति	sees / is seeing present stem paśya-
vadati	वदति	speaks / is speaking present stem vada-
paṭhati	पठति	reads / recites present stem paṭha-
likhati	लखति	writes present stem likha-
khādati	खादति	eats present stem khāda-
pibati	पिबति	drinks irregular present stem piba-
hasati	हसति	laughs / smiles present stem hasa-
tiṣṭhati	तिष्ठति	stands / remains irregular present stem tiṣṭha-
bhavati	भवति	becomes / is context determines the best English

2. Sanskrit can omit a recoverable subject pronoun

saḥ gacchati means “he goes,” but gacchati alone can mean the same thing if the subject is already understood. The verb ending supplies third-person singular information; a pronoun is added for contrast, clarity, or emphasis.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
saḥ paṭhati.	सः पठति	He reads. explicit subject pronoun
paṭhati.	पठति	He/she/it reads. subject recovered from context
sā likhati.	सा लखति	She writes. sā is feminine subject form

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
tat patati.	तत् पतति	It falls. tat is neuter subject form

3. Negation is placed before what it negates

The indeclinable na means “not.” For a simple finite verb, place it directly before the verb: na gacchati, “does not go.” na never changes form.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
saḥ na gacchati.	सः न गच्छति	He does not go. na is indeclinable
sā na khādati.	सा न खादति	She does not eat. same na with any subject
tat na patati.	तत् न पतति	It does not fall. verb remains third-person singular

A note on “is”

The verb asti means “is,” but Sanskrit often omits it in a present-tense identity or description: sā śiṣyā, literally “she student,” naturally “she is a student.” Learn both patterns; do not insert asti automatically into every sentence.

Guided practice

Translate: sā paṭhati; saḥ na likhati; tat patati. Then remove the subject pronoun from the first sentence.

Check: “She reads; he does not write; it falls.” Without the overt subject: paṭhati - “she/he/it reads,” with the intended subject supplied by context.

Close the lesson

- The Sanskrit present can express simple, progressive, or habitual present action.
- Third-person singular present forms commonly end in -ti.
- Subject pronouns are optional when the verb and context already identify the subject.

Before tomorrow

Choose five verbs from today’s list. Say each affirmative and negative: gacchati / na gacchati.

Day 5: Masculine a-stems: subject and object

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. The first declension pattern

Many high-frequency masculine stems end in short -a. In the singular, the ordinary subject form ends in **-aḥ**, and the ordinary direct-object form ends in **-am**. The stem-final a and ending are best learned as a complete form.

Stem and meaning	Subject: nominative singular	Object: accusative singular
rāma- - Rama	rāmaḥ	rāmam
bāla- - boy	bālaḥ	bālam
nara- - man/person	naraḥ	naram
aśva- - horse	aśvaḥ	aśvam
deva- - god/deity	devaḥ	devam

2. Switching the endings switches the roles

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
rāmaḥ kṛṣṇam paśyati.	रामः कृष्णं पश्यति	Rama sees Krishna. rāmaḥ = nominative; kṛṣṇam/kṛṣṇam = accusative
kṛṣṇaḥ rāmam paśyati.	कृष्णः रामं पश्यति	Krishna sees Rama. the lexical meanings are unchanged; the roles reverse
bālaḥ aśvam paśyati.	बालः अश्वं पश्यति	The boy sees the horse. learning forms are shown before full external sandhi
aśvaḥ bālam paśyati.	अश्वः बालं पश्यति	The horse sees the boy. verb still agrees with one subject

3. Do not identify the subject by “first word”

rāmam kṛṣṇaḥ paśyati still means “Krishna sees Rama.” The object has been moved forward, perhaps for topic or contrast. Parsing must begin from endings: -aḥ suggests nominative singular; -am/-am suggests accusative singular.

Sandhi alert

In connected Classical Sanskrit, final -aḥ may become -o before a voiced sound: rāmaḥ + vadati rāmo vadati. This course sometimes leaves forms analytically separated so the ending remains visible. You are not tested on that change yet.

Guided practice

Reverse the roles in devaḥ naram paśyati without changing the vocabulary or verb.

Check: naraḥ devam paśyati - “The man/person sees the deity.” Both nouns must change case.

Close the lesson

- Masculine a-stem nominative singular normally ends in -aḥ.
- Masculine a-stem accusative singular normally ends in -am, often surface -aṃ.
- Case endings-not first position-identify subject and object.

Before tomorrow

Decline the five stems in today's table from memory, first as subject forms and then as object forms.

Day 6: Neuter a-stems: the same-form rule

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. Neuter nominative and accusative match

For every neuter noun and pronoun in Sanskrit, the nominative and accusative forms are identical within the same number. This is a language-wide rule, not merely a feature of -a stems. For neuter a-stems, both singular forms end in **-am**.

Stem and meaning	Subject: nominative singular	Object: accusative singular
phala- - fruit	phalam	phalam
pustaka- - book	pustakam	pustakam
jala- - water	jalam	jalam
vana- - forest	vanam	vanam
nagara- - city	nagaram	nagaram

2. Syntax and meaning disambiguate the identical form

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
phalaṃ patati.	फलं पतति	The fruit falls. phalam is nominative: it is what falls
bālaḥ phalaṃ khādati.	बालः फलं खादति	The boy eats the fruit. phalam is accusative: it is what is eaten
jalaṃ patati.	जलं पतति	Water falls. jalam is the subject
sā jalaṃ pibati.	सा जलं पबिति	She drinks water. jalam is the object
pustakaṃ patati.	पुस्तकं पतति	The book falls. intransitive patati has no direct object
rāmaḥ pustakaṃ paṭhati.	रामः पुस्तकं पठति	Rama reads the book. transitive paṭhati takes an object here

3. Transitive and intransitive verbs

A **transitive** use can take a direct object: someone sees something. An **intransitive** verb does not take a direct object: something falls. When neuter subject and object forms look alike, the verb's meaning is a major clue.

Reliable rule

Do not decide that every form in -am is an object. A neuter nominative singular also ends in -am. Parse gender and syntax together.

Guided practice

In each sentence, identify whether pustakam is subject or object: (a) pustakaṃ patati; (b) sā pustakaṃ paṭhati.

Check: (a) subject/nominative because the book falls; (b) direct object/accusative because she reads the book.

Close the lesson

- Neuter nominative and accusative forms are identical in every number.
- For neuter a-stems, the singular nominative/accusative is -am.
- Verb meaning and sentence structure distinguish an identical neuter form's role.

Before tomorrow

Write two sentences with phalam: once as the thing that falls and once as the thing that someone eats.

Day 7: Week 1 integration and diagnostic

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

The four-pass parsing method

Use the same procedure every time. Do not translate the first word and improvise from there.

Pass	Action	Example: <i>rāmaṃ sītā paśyati</i>
1. Circle the finite verb	Identify action and provisional person/number.	<i>paśyati</i> - sees; third singular
2. Find nominative	Look for the subject form.	<i>sītā</i> - feminine nominative singular
3. Find accusative	Look for a direct object licensed by the verb.	<i>rāmaṃ</i> - masculine accusative singular
4. Translate naturally	Use roles, not Sanskrit position.	"Sita sees Rama."

Integrated examples

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
<i>rāmaṃ sītā paśyati.</i>	रामं सीता पश्यति	Sita sees Rama. O-S-V surface order
<i>phalaṃ bālaḥ khādati.</i>	फलं बालः खादति	The boy eats the fruit. neuter object placed first
<i>pustakaṃ patati.</i>	पुस्तकं पतति	The book falls. neuter subject; no object
<i>devaḥ naraṃ na paśyati.</i>	देवः नरं न पश्यति	The deity does not see the man. na negates the verb
<i>sā jalaṃ pibati.</i>	सा जलं पibति	She drinks water. feminine subject pronoun
<i>tat na patati.</i>	तत् न पतति	It does not fall. neuter subject pronoun

Error clinic

Tempting error	Why it fails	Repair
"The first noun is the subject."	Object-first order is possible.	Read endings before order.
"Every -am word is an object."	Neuter nominative singular also has -am.	Check gender and verb meaning.
"The object changes the verb."	Active finite verb agrees with subject.	Link verb to nominative.
"Every English 'is' needs asti."	Present copula is often omitted.	Accept a nominative predicate without asti.

Mini-diagnostic

1. Parse and translate *aśvaṃ bālaḥ paśyati*.
2. Reverse subject and object by changing endings only.

3. Explain why phalam could be nominative or accusative in isolation.

Check: 1. bālaḥ nominative subject; aśvam accusative object; paśyati third singular: "The boy sees the horse." 2. aśvaḥ bālaḥ paśyati. 3. Neuter nominative and accusative are identical; context must identify the role.

Close the lesson

- A stable parsing procedure prevents English word-order habits from taking over.
- Noun form, verb meaning, and agreement must be analyzed together.
- If this diagnostic was below 80%, repeat Days 5-7 before adding verb persons.

Before tomorrow

Complete the Day 7 workbook checkpoint closed-book. Mark not only wrong answers but also answers you guessed.

Day 8: Person and number: the nine-cell grid

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. Three persons

A finite verb locates its subject relative to the speech situation. First person includes the speaker (“I/we”), second person addresses the hearer (“you”), and third person refers to anyone or anything else.

Western label	Core subject	Traditional Sanskrit label	Literal sense
third person	he, she, it, they; named nouns	prathama-puruṣa	first/initial person
second person	you	madhyama-puruṣa	middle person
first person	I, we	uttama-puruṣa	highest/final person

Terminology trap

Traditional Sanskrit tables usually list prathama, madhyama, uttama-equivalent to Western third, second, first person. This course shows Western labels first and the Sanskrit terms beside them.

2. Three numbers

Sanskrit does not divide number into only singular and plural. **Dual** is required when exactly two referents are meant. The verb therefore has three numbers in each of three persons: a nine-cell grid.

Person \ Number	Singular: one	Dual: exactly two	Plural: more than two
3rd / prathama	he/she/it; one noun	those two	they
2nd / madhyama	you, one person	you two	you all
1st / uttama	I	we two	we

3. Agreement is a coordinate match

To select a present ending, ask two questions about the subject: **which person?** and **which number?** The object's person, gender, and number do not choose the active verb ending.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
saḥ paśyati.	सः पश्यति	He sees. third person + singular
tau paśyataḥ.	तौ पश्यतः।	Those two see. third person + dual
te paśyanti.	ते पश्यन्ति	They see. third person + plural
tvam paśyasi.	त्वम् पश्यसि	You see. second person + singular
aham paśyāmi.	अहम् पश्यामि	I see. first person + singular

Guided practice

Name the person-number cell needed for each subject: aham, tvam, rāmau (two Ramas), bālāḥ (boys).

Check: aham: first singular; tvam: second singular; rāmau: third dual; bālāḥ: third plural.

Close the lesson

- Person identifies speaker, addressee, or other.
- Sanskrit number distinguishes one, exactly two, and more than two.
- A finite verb ending occupies one of nine person-number cells.

Before tomorrow

Draw a blank 3×3 grid. Label persons down the side and numbers across the top without looking.

Day 9: Subject pronouns and -mi, -si, -ti

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. Singular subject pronouns

Person	Pronoun	Devanāgarī	English	Verb ending
1st singular	aham	अहम्	I	-mi
2nd singular	tvam	त्वम्	you	-si
3rd singular masculine	saḥ	सः	he / that one	-ti
3rd singular feminine	sā	सा	she / that one	-ti
3rd singular neuter	tat	तत्	it / that	-ti

2. Attach singular endings to an a-stem

With a regular present stem such as paśya-, third and second singular are transparent: paśya-ti, paśya-si. Before the first-person ending, the stem vowel is long: paśyā-mi.

Subject	Stem + ending	Finished form	Translation
aham	paśyā- + mi	paśyāmi	I see
tvam	paśya- + si	paśyasi	you see
saḥ / sā / tat	paśya- + ti	paśyati	he/she/it sees

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
aham gacchāmi.	अहं गच्छामि	I go / I am going. first singular; aham surfaces as aham before g
tvam gacchasi.	त्वं गच्छसि	You go / you are going. second singular
saḥ gacchati.	सः गच्छति	He goes. third singular
sā paṭhati.	सा पठति	She reads. third singular; gender does not change the verb
tat patati.	तत् पतति	It falls. third singular neuter subject
likhāmi.	लिखामि	I write. pronoun omitted; ending identifies the subject
na likhasi.	न लिखसि	You do not write. subject inferred from -si

3. Gender belongs to third-person pronouns, not present endings

saḥ, sâ, and tat differ because pronouns decline for gender. The verb paśyati is the same with all three because finite present endings mark person and number, not gender.

Guided practice

Conjugate vada- “speak” with aham, tvam, and sâ. Then omit each subject pronoun.

Check: ahaṃ vadāmi / vadāmi; tvaṃ vadasi / vadasi; sâ vadati / vadati.

Close the lesson

- Singular active present endings are first -mi, second -si, third -ti.
- Regular a-stem first singular lengthens a to ā before -mi.
- The subject pronoun may be omitted because the verb ending still expresses person and number.

Before tomorrow

Conjugate gaccha-, vada-, and paṭha- through the three singular persons aloud.

Day 10: Object pronouns: me, you, him, her, it

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. Subject and object forms are different lexemes in the sentence

Meaning	Subject / nominative	Object / accusative	Devanāgarī object
I / me	aham	mām (or short mā)	माम् मा
you (singular)	tvam	tvām (or short tvā)	त्वाम् त्वा
he / him	saḥ	tam	तम्
she / her	sā	tām	ताम्
it / it	tat	tat	तत्

The short forms mā and tvā are enclitic alternatives used in eligible positions; they are not normally placed at the very beginning of a sentence. Use the full forms mām and tvām until the contrast is secure.

2. Subject controls the verb; object controls nothing on the active verb

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
aham tvām paśyāmi.	अहं त्वां पश्यामि	I see you. aham first singular paśyāmi
tvam mām paśyasi.	त्वं मां पश्यसि	You see me. tvam second singular paśyasi
saḥ tām paśyati.	सः तां पश्यति	He sees her. saḥ third singular paśyati
sā tam paśyati.	सा तं पश्यति	She sees him. sā third singular paśyati
aham tat paśyāmi.	अहं तत् पश्यामि	I see it. tat is neuter accusative and nominative
tvām saḥ paśyati.	त्वां सः पश्यति	He sees you. object-first order; saḥ still controls the verb

3. A mechanical sentence-building method

Step	Question	Example answer
1	Who sees?	I nominative aham
2	Whom do I see?	her accusative tām
3	Which verb cell matches the subject?	first singular paśyāmi
Result	Assemble in neutral S-O-V order.	aham tām paśyāmi

No “object conjugation” here

The object is **declined** into the accusative. The verb is **conjugated** for the subject. A later passive construction reorganizes these relations, but that is a different grammatical voice.

Guided practice

Translate into Sanskrit: (a) You see him. (b) She sees you. (c) I do not see her.

Check: (a) tvam tam paśyasi. (b) sā tvam paśyati. (c) aham tām na paśyāmi.

Close the lesson

- Use mām, tvām, tam, tām, tat as singular direct-object forms.
- The subject’s person and number determine -mi, -si, or -ti.
- An object can be placed first without becoming the subject.

Before tomorrow

Say all five object pronouns in order, then build one sentence with each. Check only after speaking.

Day 11: Exactly two-and more: noun number

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. Nominative and accusative a/ā-stem chart

Learn number as part of each form. The dual is not an optional poetic feature: exactly two ordinary referents normally require dual noun and verb forms.

Pattern	Case	Singular	Dual	Plural
masculine rāma-	nominative	rāmaḥ	rāmau	rāmāḥ
	accusative	rāmam	rāmau	rāmān
feminine sītā-	nominative	sītā	sīte	sītāḥ
	accusative	sītām	sīte	sītāḥ
neuter phala-	nominative	phalam	phale	phalāni
	accusative	phalam	phale	phalāni

2. Three structural observations

- **Dual nominative = dual accusative** for these a/ā-stem paradigms.
- **Neuter nominative = accusative** in singular, dual, and plural.
- **Feminine ā-stem nominative plural = accusative plural** in the pattern introduced here.

3. Agreement in complete sentences

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
rāmau phalaṃ khādataḥ.	रामौ फलं खादतः।	Two Ramas eat a fruit. dual subject dual verb
rāmaḥ phale khādati.	रामः फले खादति	Rama eats two fruits. singular subject singular verb; dual object does not affect it
rāmāḥ phalāni khādanti.	रामाः फलानि खादन्ति	The Ramas eat fruits. plural subject plural verb
sīte pustakaṃ paṭhataḥ.	सीते पुस्तकं पठतः।	Two Sitas read a book. feminine dual subject; verb has no gender marking
sītā pustakāni paṭhati.	सीता पुस्तकानि पठति	Sita reads books. plural object; singular verb

4. Count by the subject, not by the closest noun

In rāmaḥ phalāni khādati, the noun immediately before the verb is plural, but it is an object. The singular subject rāmaḥ requires singular khādati. Sanskrit agreement is syntactic, not proximity-based.

Guided practice

Change rāmaḥ phalaṃ khādati so that (a) Rama eats two fruits; (b) two Ramas eat one fruit; (c) many Ramas eat many fruits.

Check: (a) rāmaḥ phale khādati. (b) rāmau phalaṃ khādataḥ. (c) rāmāḥ phalāni khādanti.

Close the lesson

- Dual means exactly two and triggers dual agreement when the subject is dual.
- Object number changes the noun form but not the active verb ending.
- Neuter nominative and accusative remain identical in all three numbers.

Before tomorrow

Reproduce the six-row a/ā-stem chart from memory. Circle every cell where nominative and accusative are identical.

Day 12: The complete present parasmaipada

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. Nine forms of paśya- “see”

The ending set introduced here is traditionally called parasmaipada. For regular a-stem present verbs, the pattern is highly reusable.

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
3rd / prathama	paśyati he/she/it sees	paśyataḥ those two see	paśyanti they see
2nd / madhyama	paśyasi you see	paśyathaḥ you two see	paśyatha you all see
1st / uttama	paśyāmi I see	paśyāvaḥ we two see	paśyāmaḥ we see

2. Ending-only chart

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural	Memory cue
3rd	-ti	-taḥ	-anti	t-row
2nd	-si	-thaḥ	-tha	th marks 2nd dual/plural
1st	-mi	-vaḥ	-maḥ	first-person stem has long ā

3. Apply the pattern, not a memorized block

Present stem	3rd plural	2nd dual	1st plural
gaccha- - go	gacchanti	gacchathaḥ	gacchāmaḥ
vada- - speak	vadanti	vadathaḥ	vadāmaḥ
paṭha- - read	paṭhanti	paṭhathaḥ	paṭhāmaḥ
likha- - write	likhanti	likhathaḥ	likhāmaḥ
khāda- - eat	khādanti	khādathaḥ	khādāmaḥ

4. Read agreement across a sentence

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
rāmau sītāṃ paśyataḥ.	रामौ सीतां पश्यतः।	The two Ramas see Sita. third dual subject
yūyaṃ rāmaṃ paśyatha.	यूयं रामं पश्यथ।	You all see Rama. second plural subject
vayaṃ phalāni khādāmaḥ.	वयं फलानि खादामः।	We eat fruits. first plural subject
āvāṃ pustakaṃ paṭhāvaḥ.	आवां पुस्तकं पठावः।	We two read a book. first dual subject

Guided practice

Without a chart, give all nine forms of vada- in the order: third row, second row, first row; singular, dual, plural.

Check: vadati, vadataḥ, vadanti; vadasi, vadathaḥ, vadatha; vadāmi, vadāvaḥ, vadāmaḥ.

Close the lesson

- The present parasmaipada has nine person-number forms.
- Third: -ti, -taḥ, -anti; second: -si, -thaḥ, -tha; first: -mi, -vaḥ, -maḥ.
- Regular a-stem first-person forms show long ā before the ending.

Before tomorrow

Conjugate one new stem by rows and another by columns. This prevents the chart from becoming a memorized chant with no coordinates.

Day 13: Full I/we and you: asmad and yuṣmad

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. First-person pronoun in cases 1 and 2

Role	Singular	Dual	Plural
Subject / nominative	aham - I	āvām - we two	vayam - we
Object / accusative	mām - me	āvām - us two	asmān - us

2. Second-person pronoun in cases 1 and 2

Role	Singular	Dual	Plural
Subject / nominative	tvam - you	yuvām - you two	yūyam - you all
Object / accusative	tvām - you	yuvām - you two	yuṣmān - you all

3. Irregular stems are normal for pronouns

The dictionary labels asmad and yuṣmad name the paradigms, but those exact stems are not the nominative forms you speak. Frequent pronouns preserve old and irregular formations; learn each cell as a meaningful form.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
āvām tvām paśyāvaḥ.	आवां त्वां पश्यावः।	We two see you. āvām subject first dual
yuvām mām paśyathaḥ.	युवां माम् पश्यथः।	You two see me. yuvām subject second dual
vayam yuṣmān paśyāmaḥ.	वयं युष्मान् पश्यामः।	We see you all. vayam subject first plural
yūyam asmān paśyatha.	यूयम् अस्मान् पश्यथ।	You all see us. yūyam subject second plural
asmān saḥ paśyati.	अस्मान् सः पश्यति।	He sees us. object first; saḥ controls third singular

4. Short unaccented alternatives

Sanskrit also has short enclitic forms such as mā “me,” tvā “you,” nau “us two,” vām “you two,” naḥ “us,” and vaḥ “you all.” They have positional restrictions and additional case values. Recognize them, but use the full accusative forms in this phase.

Guided practice

Translate: (a) We two see you all. (b) You all see us two. (c) He sees us.

Check: (a) āvām yuṣmān paśyāvaḥ. (b) yūyam āvām paśyatha. (c) saḥ asmān paśyati.

Close the lesson

- First-person subject forms: aham, āvām, vayam; object forms: mām, āvām, asmān.
- Second-person subject forms: tvam, yuvām, yūyam; object forms: tvām, yuvām, yuṣmān.
- Dual subject and object forms happen to match in both paradigms.

Before tomorrow

Recite each two-row table by number: singular subject/object, dual subject/object, plural subject/object.

Day 14: Cumulative review and error clinic

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

Five high-value corrections

Incorrect or misleading	Diagnosis	Correct pattern
aham paśyati	first-person subject with third-person verb	aham paśyāmi
tvām paśyasi = “you see”	tvām is accusative object, not subject	tvam paśyasi
rāmaḥ phalāni khādanti	verb wrongly follows plural object	rāmaḥ phalāni khādati
rāmau paśyati	dual subject with singular verb	rāmau paśyataḥ
“An -am form must be object.”	neuter nominative may end in -am	phalam patati

Agreement ladder

When a finite verb looks wrong, climb this ladder: (1) identify the nominative subject; (2) determine its person; (3) determine its number; (4) select the matching verb cell; (5) ignore the object while choosing the active ending.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
yūyaṁ phalaṁ khādatha.	यूयं फलं खादथ।	You all eat a fruit. second plural
āvāṁ pustakāni paṭhāvaḥ.	आवां पुस्तकानि पठावः।	We two read books. first dual; plural object
rāmau sītāṁ paśyataḥ.	रामौ सीतां पश्यतः।	Two Ramas see Sita. third dual
phale patataḥ.	फले पततः।	Two fruits fall. neuter dual subject
sītāḥ rāmaṁ paśyanti.	सीताः रामं पश्यन्ति।	The Sitas see Rama. third plural feminine subject

Closed-book checkpoint

1. Supply the correct form of paśya-: vayam rāmaṁ _____.
2. Change “you two” from subject to object.
3. Translate yuṣmān āvāṁ paśyāvaḥ.
4. Correct phalaṁ patanti if one fruit is meant.
5. Explain why rāmau alone does not reveal nominative vs accusative.

Check: 1. paśyāmaḥ. 2. yuvām remains yuvām in the accusative dual. 3. “We two see you all.” 4. phalaṁ patati. 5. Masculine a-stem nominative and accusative dual are identical; syntax supplies the role.

**Mastery
decision**

If you missed two or more checkpoint items, repeat the relevant workbook pages before Day 15. The coming third-person paradigm is larger; it should rest on automatic person-number agreement.

Close the lesson

- Most beginner errors are mismatches among case, person, and number.
- A correct answer should be explainable by coordinates, not remembered only as a sound.
- Ambiguous forms are normal; syntax and agreement resolve them.

**Before
tomorrow**

Rebuild the nine present endings and both personal-pronoun two-row tables from a blank page.

Day 15: The third-person pronoun tad

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. Why “third-person pronoun” is really a demonstrative

Classical Sanskrit commonly uses the demonstrative paradigm tad (“that”) where English uses he, she, it, and they. Its form agrees with the referent’s gender and number and takes the case required by its own role.

Masculine tad: he / him / those men

Role	Singular	Dual	Plural
Subject / nominative	saḥ	tau	te
Object / accusative	tam	tau	tān

Feminine tad: she / her / those women

Role	Singular	Dual	Plural
Subject / nominative	sā	te	tāḥ
Object / accusative	tām	te	tāḥ

Neuter tad: it / those things

Role	Singular	Dual	Plural
Subject / nominative	tat	te	tāni
Object / accusative	tat	te	tāni

2. Agreement and antecedent

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
saḥ tām paśyati.	सः तां पश्यति	He sees her. masculine nominative; feminine accusative
sā tam paśyati.	सा तं पश्यति	She sees him. feminine nominative; masculine accusative
tau tāni paśyataḥ.	तौ तानपिश्यतः।	Those two men see those things. masculine dual subject; neuter plural object
tāḥ tam paśyanti.	ताः तम् पश्यन्ति	Those women see him. feminine plural subject
tāni patanti.	तानपितन्ति	Those things fall. neuter plural subject
te phalaṃ khādataḥ.	ते फलं खादतः।	Those two women / two things eat a fruit. form te is morphologically ambiguous; context supplies gender

3. Ambiguity is a feature, not a defect

Forms such as *te* cover several cells. Sanskrit does not require every isolated form to identify every feature. The antecedent, verb meaning, and surrounding agreement usually resolve the intended analysis.

Guided practice

Translate with correct *tad* forms: (a) They [masculine] see her. (b) She sees them [neuter plural]. (c) Those two women see him.

Check: (a) *te tāṃ paśyanti*. (b) *sā tāni paśyati*. (c) *te taṃ paśyataḥ*.

Close the lesson

- *tad* supplies common third-person demonstrative/pronominal forms.
- The pronoun agrees in gender and number but takes nominative or accusative according to its role.
- Several *tad* forms are syncretic-one visible form represents multiple cells.

Before tomorrow

Reproduce the three two-row *tad* tables, then color-code forms that repeat across cells.

Day 16: Who sees whom? Interrogative pronouns

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. The question word takes the role it asks about

Sanskrit does not use one unchanging word for both “who?” and “whom?” The interrogative stem *kim* declines like a pronoun. Use nominative when asking for a subject and accusative when asking for a direct object.

Gender	Subject: nominative singular	Object: accusative singular
masculine	kaḥ? - who?	kam? - whom?
feminine	kā? - who?	kām? - whom?
neuter	kim? - what?	kim? - what?

2. Let the unknown determine the case

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
kaḥ paśyati?	कः पश्यति	Who sees? unknown masculine subject nominative
kā paśyati?	का पश्यति	Who [feminine] sees? unknown feminine subject
kaṃ paśyasi?	कं पश्यसि	Whom do you see? unknown masculine object accusative
kām paśyasi?	कामं पश्यसि	Whom [feminine] do you see? unknown feminine object
kiṃ patati?	किं पतति	What falls? neuter subject; kim
kiṃ paśyasi?	किं पश्यसि	What do you see? neuter object; same kim
rāmaṃ kaḥ paśyati?	रामं कः पश्यति	Who sees Rama? Rama is object; kaḥ is subject
rāmaḥ kaṃ paśyati?	रामः कं पश्यति	Whom does Rama see? Rama is subject; kaṃ is object

3. Full nominative/accusative recognition chart

Gender and role	Singular	Dual	Plural
masculine nominative	kaḥ	kau	ke
masculine accusative	kam	kau	kān
feminine nominative	kā	ke	kāḥ
feminine accusative	kām	ke	kāḥ
neuter nominative/accusative	kim	ke	kāni

Guided practice

Form Sanskrit questions for: (a) Who [masculine] sees Sita? (b) Whom [masculine] does Sita see? (c) What do you two see?

Check: (a) sītāṃ kaḥ paśyati? (b) sītā kam paśyati? (c) yuvāṃ kiṃ paśyathaḥ?

Close the lesson

- Question pronouns are declined according to their role.
- kaḥ/kā ask for a subject; kam/kām ask for an object; kim can be either neuter role.
- Word order alone cannot distinguish “who?” from “whom?”-case does.

Before tomorrow

Turn five declarative sentences from earlier lessons into questions by replacing either the subject or object with the matching interrogative.

Day 17: Adjectives agree with nouns

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

1. Agreement copies three coordinates

An adjective describing a noun normally agrees with it in **gender, number, and case**. The adjective does not have one fixed form equivalent to English “new” or “good”; it takes the form required by the noun it describes.

Meaning	Masculine singular	Feminine singular	Neuter singular
new	navaḥ / navam	navā / navām	navam / navam
white	śuklaḥ / śuklam	śuklā / śuklām	śuklam / śuklam
beautiful	sundaraḥ / sundaram	sundarī*	sundaram / sundaram
small	laghuḥ*	laghvī*	laghu*

The paired forms in the first two rows show nominative / accusative singular. Asterisks mark other stem classes included only for recognition; this lesson's production target is regular a/ā agreement with nava- and śukla-.

2. Match the noun's role

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
navaḥ bālaḥ pustakaṃ paṭhati.	नवः बालः पुस्तकं पठति	The new boy reads a book. both adjective and noun are masculine nominative singular
rāmaḥ navaṃ bālaṃ paśyati.	रामः नवं बालं पश्यति	Rama sees the new boy. both are masculine accusative singular
navā bālā pustakaṃ paṭhati.	नवा बाला पुस्तकं पठति	The new girl reads a book. feminine nominative singular
rāmaḥ navāṃ bālāṃ paśyati.	रामः नवां बालां पश्यति	Rama sees the new girl. feminine accusative singular
navaṃ pustakaṃ patati.	नवं पुस्तकं पतति	The new book falls. neuter nominative singular
sā navaṃ pustakaṃ paṭhati.	सा नवं पुस्तकं पठति	She reads the new book. neuter accusative; visible form is identical

3. Predicate adjectives

An adjective can be predicative: phalaṃ madhuraṃ, “the fruit is sweet.” Both words are nominative neuter singular, and present asti may be omitted. Do not label madhuraṃ accusative merely because it ends in -am.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
phalaṃ madhuraṃ.	फलं मधुरम्।	The fruit is sweet. two neuter nominative singular forms
bālaḥ kuśalaḥ.	बालः कुशलः।	The boy is well / skillful. two masculine nominative singular forms

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
bālā kuśalā.	बाला कुशला।	The girl is well / skillful. two feminine nominative singular forms

Analytic spelling

Adjective-noun examples are shown with their underlying word forms visible. Full external sandhi may alter a boundary, such as navaḥ + bālāḥ navo bālāḥ.

Guided practice

Add the correct form of nava-: (a) ___ rāmaḥ; (b) rāmaḥ ___ pustakaṃ paṭhati; (c) sā ___ bālāṃ paśyati.

Check: (a) navaḥ rāmaḥ; (b) navaṃ pustakam; (c) navāṃ bālām.

Close the lesson

- Adjectives copy gender, number, and case from the noun they describe.
- Neuter predicate adjectives can end in -am while remaining nominative.
- Learn adjective agreement through noun phrases, not isolated endings.

Before tomorrow

Build six phrases with nava-: masculine, feminine, and neuter in nominative and accusative singular.

Day 18: The second present ending set: ātmanepada

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart. Suggested study time: 55-65 minutes.

1. Two personal-ending sets

Many Sanskrit roots select parasmaipada endings, many select ātmanepada endings, and some can use both with lexical or contextual differences. The traditional labels are important, but do not reduce them mechanically to English “active” versus “reflexive.” Learn a root together with the ending set it normally uses.

What ātmanepada is not

It is not the passive. labhate is an active-meaning finite form-“he/she obtains”-with the ātmanepada ending set. A true passive has its own stem formation and will be taught later.

2. Present ātmanepada of labha- “obtain, receive”

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
3rd / prathama	labhate	labhete	labhante
2nd / madhyama	labhase	labhethe	labhadhve
1st / uttama	labhe	labhāvahe	labhāmahe

3. Ending comparison

Person-number	Parasmaipada: paśya-	Ātmanepada: labha-
3rd singular	paśya-ti	labha-te
3rd dual	paśya-taḥ	labh-ete
3rd plural	paśy-anti	labh-ante
2nd singular	paśya-si	labha-se
2nd dual	paśya-taḥ	labh-ethe
2nd plural	paśya-tha	labha-dhve
1st singular	paśyā-mi	labh-e
1st dual	paśyā-vaḥ	labh-āvahe
1st plural	paśyā-maḥ	labh-āmahe

4. Agreement remains subject-based

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
ahaṃ phalaṃ labhe.	अहं फलं लभे।	I obtain a fruit. first singular ātmanepada
tvaṃ pustakaṃ labhase.	त्वं पुस्तकं लभसे।	You obtain a book. second singular
saḥ jalaṃ labhate.	सः जलं लभते।	He obtains water. third singular
tau pustake labhete.	तौ पुस्तके लभेते।	Those two obtain two books. third dual subject
te phalāni labhante.	ते फलानि लभन्ते।	They obtain fruits. third plural subject
vayaṃ pustakāni labhāmahe.	वयं पुस्तकानि लभामहे।	We obtain books. first plural

Guided practice

Give the ātmanepada forms of labha- for: you two, we, they, I.

Check: labhethe, labhāmahe, labhante, labhe.

Close the lesson

- Ātmanepada is a personal-ending set, not another name for passive voice.
- The nine present endings still encode person and number of the subject.
- Learn each root with its normal present stem and pada.

Before tomorrow

Write the paśya- and labha- nine-cell tables side by side. Underline only the endings.

Day 19: Roots, present stems, and high-frequency irregulars

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart. Suggested study time: 55-65 minutes.

1. The dictionary root is not a plug-in stem

A Sanskrit root is an abstract lexical base. Different tense/mood systems form stems from it, sometimes transparently and sometimes through inherited changes. To speak or parse the present, memorize the present stem-not only the root.

Root	Present stem	3rd singular	Meaning
gam	gaccha-	gacchati	go
ḍṛś	paśya-	paśyati	see
sthā	tiṣṭha-	tiṣṭhati	stand, remain
pā	piba-	pibati	drink
bhū	bhava-	bhavati	become, be
as	irregular	asti	be, exist

2. Conjugate the present stem normally

Once you know gaccha-, most of its present paradigm takes the regular parasmaipada endings: gacchati, gacchataḥ, gacchanti; gacchasi, gacchathaḥ, gacchatha; gacchāmi, gacchāvaḥ, gacchāmaḥ.

3. The present of as “be”

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
3rd / prathama	asti	staḥ	santi
2nd / madhyama	asi	sthaḥ	stha
1st / uttama	asmi	svaḥ	smaḥ
IAST transliteration		Devanāgarī	English / note
ahaṃ śiṣyaḥ asmi.		अहं शिष्यः अस्मि	I am a student. first singular asmi
tvam śiṣyaḥ asi.		त्वं शिष्यः असि	You are a student. second singular asi
saḥ śiṣyaḥ asti.		सः शिष्यः अस्ति	He is a student. third singular asti
āvāṃ śiṣyau svaḥ.		आवां शिष्यौ स्वः।	We two are students. predicate agrees; first dual svaḥ

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
yūyaṃ śiṣyāḥ stha.	यूयं शिष्याः स्थ।	You all are students. second plural stha
te śiṣyāḥ santi.	ते शिष्याः सन्ति।	They are students. third plural santi

External sandhi and natural style may alter or omit forms of as. The analytic examples keep the components visible for learning.

Guided practice

Conjugate gaccha- for “we,” then use as for “we are students.”

Check: gacchāmaḥ; vāyaṃ śiṣyāḥ smaḥ.

Close the lesson

- Learn root, present stem, meaning, and pada as one lexical package.
- Irregular-looking stems can still take regular endings.
- as has its own high-frequency paradigm and is often omitted as present copula.

Before tomorrow

Make five four-part cards: root present stem third singular English meaning. Add the complete as grid as a sixth card.

Day 20: Capstone: parse and compose

Today's target

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to use the new pattern without looking at a chart.
Suggested study time: 60-75 minutes.

1. Read the passage without translating word by word

First underline finite verbs. Then identify each verb's subject by case and agreement. Only afterward connect direct objects and produce natural English.

Capstone passage

rāmaḥ sītāṃ paśyati. sītā rāmaṃ paśyati. tau hasataḥ. phalaṃ patati. rāmaḥ tat paśyati. sītā phalaṃ khādati. atha tau pustakāni paṭhataḥ.

रामः सीतां पश्यति। सीता रामं पश्यति। तौ हसतः। फलं पतति। रामः तत् पश्यति। सीता फलं खादति। अथ तौ पुस्तकानि पठतः।

2. Model parse

Form	Morphology	Syntactic job	Meaning
rāmaḥ	masc. nom. sg.	subject of paśyati	Rama
sītāṃ	fem. acc. sg.	direct object	Sita
paśyati	present 3rd sg. P	finite verb	sees
tau	masc. nom. dual	subject of hasataḥ	those two / they two
hasataḥ	present 3rd dual P	finite verb	laugh/smile
phalaṃ	neut. nom. sg.	subject of patati	fruit
tat	neut. acc. sg.	object of paśyati	it
pustakāni	neut. acc. pl.	object of paṭhataḥ	books

Translation: “Rama sees Sita. Sita sees Rama. The two laugh. A fruit falls. Rama sees it. Sita eats the fruit. Then the two read books.”

3. Independent production protocol

English intention	Choose subject	Choose object	Conjugate
We two see them (masc.).	āvām - 1st dual	tān - masc. acc. plural	paśyāvaḥ
Finished Sanskrit			āvām tān paśyāvaḥ
Those women read two books.	tāḥ - fem. nom. plural	pustake - neut. acc. dual	paṭhanti
Finished Sanskrit			tāḥ pustake paṭhanti

Final assessment: 30 points

- Forms (8 pts):** Write nominative and accusative singular/dual/plural of rāma- and phala-.
- Pronouns (6 pts):** Give Sanskrit for I/me, we two/us two, we/us; you/you, you two/you two, you all/you all.

3. **Verbs (6 pts):** Conjugate paśya- in all nine present parasmaipada cells.
4. **Parsing (5 pts):** Parse yuṣmān tau paśyataḥ and translate.
5. **Composition (5 pts):** Translate “You all do not see us; we see you all.”

Check: 1. rāmaḥ/rāmam, rāmau/rāmau, rāmāḥ/rāmān; phalam/phalam, phale/phale, phalāni/phalāni. 2. aham/mām, āvām/āvām, vayam/asmān; tvam/tvām, yuvām/yuvām, yūyam/yuṣmān. 3. paśyati, paśyataḥ, paśyanti; paśyasi, paśyathaḥ, paśyatha; paśyāmi, paśyāvaḥ, paśyāmaḥ. 4. yuṣmān = 2nd-person acc. plural object; tau = masc. nom. dual subject; paśyataḥ = 3rd dual present: “Those two see you all.” 5. yūyam asmān na paśyatha; vyaṃ yuṣmān paśyāmaḥ.

Pass standard

24/30 with no section below half-credit means you are ready for the full case system. If agreement or pronouns remain weak, repeat Days 12-16; if case roles remain weak, repeat Days 5-7 and 11.

Close the lesson

- Parse before translating.
- Build Sanskrit by choosing roles, declining nominals, and only then conjugating the subject’s verb.
- You now have a functional subject-object-verb foundation; the next phase expands cases and stem classes.

Before tomorrow

Complete the final assessment again in seven days. Spaced success-not same-day familiarity-is the real completion test.

The full Sanskrit roadmap

The 20-day foundation is Phase 1 of a six-phase reading curriculum. The durations below assume five study sessions per week. Move by mastery rather than calendar pressure.

Phase	Approx. weeks	Core content	Exit performance
1. Sentence foundation	4	IAST; nom./acc.; pronouns; present P/Ā endings	parse and compose controlled S-O-V sentences
2. Nominal system	5-8	all eight cases; a/ā, i/u, ṛ, consonant stems; adjectives; numerals	parse ordinary noun phrases without a paradigm beside you
3. Verb system	9-12	imperative, imperfect, optative, future; participles; infinitive; gerund	track time, mood, and non-finite clauses
4. Sandhi and compounds	13-16	vowel/consonant/visarga sandhi; tatpuruṣa, karmadhāraya, bahuvrīhi, dvandva	split common joined forms and analyze compounds
5. Syntax and voice	17-20	passive; relative-correlative; case syntax; absolutes; subordinate relations	read adapted prose with a dictionary
6. Guided texts	21-24+	Pañcatantra prose, Bhagavad Gītā selections, then chosen text tradition	produce a grammatical prose order and defensible translation

Phase 2: recommended lesson order

1. Instrumental: means and accompaniment; dative: recipient and purpose.
2. Ablative: source and cause; genitive: possession and relationship; locative: place and setting.
3. Vocative and direct address; case-choice review with minimal pairs.
4. Masculine/neuter i- and u-stems; feminine ī- and ū-stems.
5. ṛ-stems and common kinship nouns; consonant stems in -ant, -in, -as, and -man.
6. Adjective agreement across the expanded stem system.
7. Possessive and reflexive pronouns; idam/etad/adas; relative yad paired with tad.
8. Numbers 1-10 and their agreement behavior.
9. A controlled prose reader using all eight cases.
10. Cumulative morphology exam and a one-page prose translation.

Mini-glossary

English term	Sanskrit term (IAST)	Working definition
case	vibhakti	a form/category expressing a nominal's grammatical relationship
conjugation	tiṅanta formation	changing a verb for person, number, tense/mood, and ending set
declension	subanta formation	changing a nominal for gender, number, and case
direct object	karman (in the core active use)	entity directly affected, perceived, or produced
dual	dvivacana	number used for exactly two
finite verb	tiṅanta	verb form carrying personal endings
gender	liṅga	masculine, feminine, or neuter grammatical class
nominative	prathamā vibhakti	case 1; ordinary active subject/default case
accusative	dvitīyā vibhakti	case 2; ordinary direct object and several other functions
number	vacana	singular, dual, or plural
person	puruṣa	speaker, addressee, or third party
pronoun	sarvanāman	pronominal word with distinctive declension
root	dhātu	lexical verbal base from which stems are formed
sandhi	sandhi	regular sound change at a boundary
stem	aṅga / prātipadika	base to which endings are attached
subject	kartṛ in the core active analysis	controller/doer of an active finite verb

Sources and recommended companions

This course is an original teaching sequence. Paradigms and terminology were checked against the following grammars and learning resources. The course deliberately combines explicit grammar study with short meaningful sentences; no source's lesson text has been reproduced.

1. **LearnSanskrit.org, Sanskrit for Beginners.** A free, modern grammar guide with clear explanations of nominals, pronouns, and present endings. learnsanskrit.org/static/pdf/guide.pdf
2. **William Dwight Whitney, Sanskrit Grammar.** Comprehensive reference grammar covering Classical and Vedic material; useful for checking paradigms and verbal systems. [Wikisource edition](#)
3. **M. R. Kale, A Higher Sanskrit Grammar.** Detailed traditional/English-reference treatment of declension, pronouns, conjugation, and syntax. [Internet Archive record](#)
4. **University of Texas Linguistics Research Center, Ancient Sanskrit Online.** Used cautiously for general structural observations such as OV word order; its lesson texts are Vedic rather than this course's Classical target. lrc.la.utexas.edu/eieol/vedol
5. **Amarahāsa.** Free transliteration-friendly reading material. Pairing grammar with comprehensible reading keeps forms connected to meaning. en.amarahasa.com

A four-week reading bridge

Beginning in Week 2, spend 10 minutes on a very easy romanized Sanskrit story twice per week. Do not parse every word. Read for meaning first; use grammar only to clarify a pattern you have already met. This phase teaches normalized Classical Sanskrit morphology; Vedic-only forms, Pāṇinian derivational analysis, full sandhi, and metrical recitation are intentionally postponed.

Week	Grammar anchor	10-minute reading task	Evidence of progress
1	subject, object, verb	Read five controlled sentences; point to the finite verb first.	Explain who does what to whom.
2	singular pronouns	Read a short scene twice; notice where pronouns are omitted.	Recover the subject from three endings.
3	dual and plural	Underline every number contrast in a short passage.	Identify one singular, dual, and plural form.
4	tad, kim, agreement	Read once for meaning, then inspect only unfamiliar pronoun forms.	Give a one-minute oral summary in English.

Reading rule

If a passage is so difficult that you must decode nearly every word, choose an easier one. Grammar should clarify meaning-not replace reading.